



AI Search Optimization Checklist

What it takes to get cited by ChatGPT, Perplexity, and Google AI Overviews — not just ranked in blue links.

MAKE YOUR CONTENT MACHINE-READABLE

- ☐ Key facts — hours, pricing, services — exist as real text, not locked inside images or PDFs
- ☐ Headings match how people actually phrase questions, not internal jargon
- ☐ FAQ sections use genuine question-and-answer pairs
- ☐ Schema markup (FAQPage, LocalBusiness, Article) is implemented and validated

CRAWLABILITY FOR AI BOTS

- ☐ robots.txt allows GPTBot, PerplexityBot, and Google-Extended — unless you deliberately want to opt out
- ☐ An llms.txt file exists if you want to guide AI crawlers to your most important pages
- ☐ Critical content does not depend on JavaScript that a bot may fail to execute

BE CITABLE

- ☐ Each page states a direct answer near the top, not after 500 words of preamble
- ☐ Content includes specific facts, numbers, and names an AI model can quote confidently
- ☐ Author or business credentials are visible — who is saying this, and why it should be trusted

MONITOR IT

- ☐ Regularly search your own brand and services in ChatGPT, Perplexity, and Google AI Overviews
- ☐ Track referral traffic from chat.openai.com, perplexity.ai, and Gemini in analytics